



THE POINT OF BEING A GUIDE IS THAT YOU HAVE TO SHARE ALL THE EXPERIENCES, NOT JUST ON THE TRACK. YOU HAVE TO BE THERE THROUGH THE HARD TIMES IN TRAINING AND DAILY LIFE
— ALDO HUAMAN

guide runner before. I started running with Simran just nine months ago. It's strange to have to run with someone else because I'm a national-level runner myself. Because both of us have our wrists attached with a tether, I had to change my position on the starting blocks and the way I positioned my hands. It was also strange because at the finish line you have to let your runner finish first. That's always challenging because my instinct is to go first. But that's the thing, you aren't running for yourself.

'Milagro is closer to me than my family'

Runner: Neri Roxana Quispe
Guide: Aldo Milagro Huaman
(Peru)

T11 women's 1500m gold

Neri: I think the secret of being a

good guide is to communicate well. That's the number one thing. If there is no communication, it won't matter how fast I am. It's not easy to be a runner. I have been training for many years and when I was preparing for the World Championships I had to stay away from my family and my daughter. A guide is not just someone who runs along with you but someone who is closer to you than your family for those months that you prepare.

Aldo: The point of being a guide is that you have to share all the experiences, not just on the track. You have to be there through the hard times in training and daily life. It gives you that special connection that makes you feel as if you are part of the family. What unites us is our passion for running. It's important

that we both share the same values — commitment, discipline, desire, and above all, tranquility. Neri has been competing for the last 10 years and she'd never won a medal before. We had to wait so many years to win her first gold medal. Long before this reward, the real joy for me was working with her through all those years.

"When we fled as refugees, we had to flee as one"

Runner: Guillaume Junior
Atangana

Guide: Donard Nyamjua
(Refugee Paralympic Team)
T11 men's 400m gold

Guillaume: I've been running with Donard since 2019. We started out competing in Congo. After the Tokyo Olympics, we realised there was no real hope for us as athletes in Congo, so we made the decision to go to England together. It's one thing to run together on the track; it's something else to make the journey by road, foot, and then boat as refugees. It would have been impossible for me to do it by myself. What I like about Donard is that he listens to me. He takes my opinion. At first, because I didn't have my papers in England, there seemed to be no way that I could run again. But God has his plan, and we got our documentation that allowed us to run together just before the Paris Paralympics. We won a bronze medal there. I know it would not have been possible without him.

It's not easy to run with a guide